■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 18, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *This Wavytalk styler is the closest alterative to the Dyson Airwrap*

The Angle: *Dupe culture is a nonstop trending topic right now, and pitting a cheap styler against the pricey, cult-favorite Dyson Airwrap is exactly the kind of budget-vs-luxury debate that gets listeners texting in with their own dupe wins and fails.*

The Dupe Debate

- Callers: what's the one dupe you swear works just as good as the■ brand original?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/shopping/wavytalk-airshape-air-styler-set-review/

■ *Drunk British tourist tackled by Thai police after he punched Good Samaritan*

The Angle: *A wild viral clip out of Thailand - a British tourist decks the teenager trying to help him, then gets tackled by cops - it's the kind of dumb-tourist-abroad chaos that makes for an easy, funny watercooler segment.*

- **Ryan Parker**, a **21-year-old** British tourist, was arrested by Thai police on **Sept. 16**
- He'd lost his keys and was arguing with his girlfriend when a **17-year-old** stopped his motorbike to help
- Parker allegedly threw a haymaker at the teen Good Samaritan instead of thanking him
- Police reportedly had to tackle Parker to get him into custody, per **Viral Press**

The Debate Starter

- Worst way to say 'thank you' you've ever seen, or worst travel meltdown story you've got?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/video/drunk-british-tourist-tackled-by-thai-police-after-he-punched-good-samaritan/

■ *Hackers find encryption keys stored on stolen Flock camera despite company's denials--group extracts more than 27,000 clips, 1.6 million images captured in a span of 21 days from the device*

The Angle: *Flock Safety cameras are the license-plate readers watching intersections in thousands of North American towns, and the company insisted its encryption kept stolen units useless — until hackers cracked one open and proved that wrong. This is a real privacy gut-punch: a camera watching your street got popped, and everything it saw leaked.*

- **Hackers** pulled data off a **stolen Flock Safety camera** after the company said stolen units couldn't be exploited because of encryption.
- The extraction found the **encryption keys stored right on the device** — the opposite of what Flock claimed.
- The haul: over **27,000 video clips** and **1.6 million images**.
- All of that surveillance footage came from just **21 days** of the camera running.

The Debate Starter

- There's probably a Flock camera on your commute right now — does this change how you feel about it, or is it just the cost of 'safer streets'?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/cyber-security/hackers-find-encryption-key-stored-on-flock-camera-group-extracts-more-than-27-000-clips-1-6-million-images-captured-in-a-span-of-21-days-from-device

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■ *Marvel's Wolverine motorcycle section and quicktime events are getting the wrong kind of attention because "the game plays itself" and "you don't have to press anything"*

The Angle: *Marvel's Wolverine is one of the most anticipated games coming out, but early buzz is about the motorcycle chase and quicktime moments basically driving themselves - a classic gamer flashpoint about whether big-budget titles are turning into movies you barely touch.*

- Reddit's tech community is buzzing over the motorcycle section and quicktime events in **Marvel's Wolverine**
- The complaint boils down to one line: **"the game plays itself"**
- Critics say **"you don't have to press anything"** during these sequences
- It's reigniting the old gamer debate over interactive cutscenes vs. real hands-on gameplay

The Debate Starter

- Do you want games to challenge you, or is a cinematic autopilot moment actually the cool part?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gamesradar.com/games/action/marvels-wolverine-motorcycle-section-and-quicktime-events-are-getting-the-wrong-kind-of-attention-because-the-game-plays-itself-and-you-dont-have-to-press-anything/

■ *Microsoft exec called AI scraping 'the largest theft of labor in human history,' new unredacted filings reveal*

The Angle: *This is a Microsoft exec's own words, newly unsealed in court filings, essentially admitting what critics have been screaming for years about AI. It lands right in the middle of the bigger fight over whether AI companies owe creators and workers for the content that trained their models.*

- The line comes from a **Microsoft executive**, not an outside critic — now public after court filings were **unredacted**.
- The quote: AI scraping amounts to **"the largest theft of labor in human history."**
- It surfaced through litigation, adding fuel to the ongoing legal fights over how AI companies source their training data.

The Debate Starter

- If the people building AI are calling it theft behind closed doors, does that change how you feel about using it?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/17/microsoft-exec-called-ai-scraping-the-largest-theft-of-labor-in-human-history-new-unredacted-filings-reveal/

Backup options:

■ *China dominates batteries. That could become a problem for Western defence.*

The Angle: *China controls the vast majority of battery production and the raw materials behind it, and now that's raising alarms that Western militaries could be dangerously dependent on a rival for the tech powering everything from drones to submarines.*

- **China** dominates global battery manufacturing and the supply chain behind it
- Concerns are growing that this gives **China** major leverage over Western **defence** capabilities
- Modern militaries increasingly rely on batteries for drones, vehicles, and other next-gen hardware

The Debate Starter

- Should Western governments be forced to pay more to build batteries at home instead of relying on China?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.rusi.org/explore-our-research/publications/commentary/battery-gap-building-industrial-strength-military-edge

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■ *Trump says Canada having more friends is bullying*

The Angle: *Trump's taking a shot at Canada's alliances, framing teamwork among allies as a hit job on the U.S. — that's the kind of loaded rhetoric that fires up the cross-border relationship debate instantly.*

- **Donald Trump** reportedly claimed that **Canada** having more international friends/allies amounts to 'bullying' the U.S.

The Debate Starter

- Is that just classic Trump trash talk, or does it actually reveal something about how the U.S.-Canada relationship is shifting?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thebeaverton.com/2026/09/trump-says-canada-having-more-friends-is-bullying/

■■ *Judge says Trump has to give 30 days notice before demolishing Kennedy Center*

The Angle: *A federal judge just put the brakes on the Trump administration's plans for the Kennedy Center, ruling they can't start demolition without a 30-day heads-up first — a fresh flashpoint in the ongoing fight over Trump's takeover of the iconic DC arts institution.*

- A **judge** ruled the **Trump administration** must give **30 days' notice** before any demolition work at the **Kennedy Center**.
- The ruling is the latest twist in the larger battle over **Trump's** control of the **Kennedy Center**'s leadership and direction.
- The **Kennedy Center** is one of the most recognizable cultural institutions in **Washington, D.C.**, making any demolition plans a national talking point.

The Debate Starter

- Should a president be able to reshape a national arts institution like the Kennedy Center at all — or is this exactly what courts are supposed to slow down?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://abcnews.com/Politics/trump-photographed-kennedy-center-demolishedplacard-amid-fight-venues/story?id=136519219

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■■ *Manitoba to stick with daylight time year-round*

The Angle: *Manitoba is planning to ditch the twice-a-year clock switch and lock in on daylight time permanently — the kind of change every Canadian has an opinion on, because everyone's felt that groggy Monday after the time change.*

The Debate Starter

- Phones lines: would you rather have darker mornings or losing that extra hour of evening light — Manitoba just picked a side, should your province?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theglobeandmail.com/canada/article-manitoba-daylight-time-year-round/

■ *Far-right German politician heckles Carney with 'U.S.A.' chant before EU address | CBC News*

The Angle: *Canada's PM getting heckled with an American chant right before an EU speech is the kind of awkward, symbolic moment that says a lot about the populist wave rattling European politics right now.*

- **Mark Carney** was heckled just before delivering an address to the **EU**.
- A **far-right German politician** interrupted him with chants of "**U.S.A.! U.S.A.!**"
- The moment was picked up and reported by **CBC News**.

The Debate Starter

- Why would a German politician troll Canada's PM by chanting the name of a different country entirely?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/usa-heckler-carney-eu-afd-9.7348759

■■ *PM Carney says EU partnership to go to debate, vote in Parliament*

The Angle: *The PM is letting elected MPs actually debate and vote on a major Canada-EU partnership instead of just signing off on it himself — that's the kind of transparency-vs-speed tension that gets people talking about how big deals should get made.*

- **PM Mark Carney** says the Canada-**EU partnership** will go to a formal **debate and vote in Parliament**
- Puts the deal's fate in the hands of MPs rather than just the executive branch

The Debate Starter

- Should big international deals like this always get a Parliament vote, or does that just slow Canada down?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/pm-carney-says-eu-partnership-to-go-to-debate-vote-in-parliament/

Backup options:

■ *New cat species identified for the 1st time in a century*

The Angle: *This is the first new living cat species named in over 100 years, discovered hiding in Bolivia's cloud forest — a genuinely rare science headline that gives the hosts a fun, easy-to-love break from the news cycle.*

- The newly identified species is a **small wild cat** living in **Bolivia's cloud forest**
- It's the **first new living cat species** formally named and described in **more than a century**
- Discoveries like this are exceptionally rare — most new cat classifications come from splitting up known species, not finding one entirely new

The Curiosity Corner

- If you discovered a brand new species tomorrow, what would you name it?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Introduce the mystery cat** - 30 seconds -> Host reads the basics: tiny wild cat, Bolivian cloud forest, first new cat species in 100+ years
- **Step 2: Name That Cat** - 1-2 minutes -> Both hosts pitch their own name for the new species before revealing (or joking about) what scientists actually called it
- **Step 3: Phone-in fun** - 2-3 minutes -> Ask listeners to call/text their pick for the cat's name or their own 'if I discovered a species' idea

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/science/tilcayo-tiger-cat-new-species-9.7349140?cmp=rss

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■■ *'Cocaine eyes' to cash bribes: 5 revelations from Project South wiretaps*

The Angle: *A major corruption investigation just had its wiretaps go public, and the code language allegedly used — including the phrase "cocaine eyes" for cash bribes — is the kind of bizarre detail that makes a serious story instantly shareable.*

The Jaw-Drop Line

- What's the weirdest code word you'd invent if you had to talk about dirty money on a wiretap?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/toronto/project-south-cocaine-eyes-9.7348668?cmp=rss

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■ *At Issue | Is Carney's Europe pivot in Canada's best interest?*

The Angle: *Canada's PM is pivoting hard toward the EU for trade and investment while a former PM defends walking away from the Americans — this is the trade-war soap opera Canadians can't stop watching.*

- **Prime Minister Mark Carney** is pushing to deepen ties with the **European Union**
- The panel debates whether the EU pivot is actually in **Canada's best interest**
- The **Liberals** are making a fresh push to lure **foreign investment** into Canada
- Former PM **Stephen Harper** publicly backs the call to walk away from **U.S. trade talks**

The Debate Starter

- Is Canada smart to lean on Europe, or are we just poking the bear next door?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/player/play/9.7348953?cmp=rss

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *See the new 'SNL' cast members, plus our Grace Reiter interview*

The Angle: *SNL's Season 52 cast additions always spark instant curiosity, but this one's got a viral hook - one of the new featured players got there off a YouTube parody blowing up online, which is basically the internet-fame-to-primetime dream.*

- **SNL** added two new featured players ahead of **Season 52**: **Saidah Belo-Osagie** and **Grace Reiter**
- **Grace Reiter** went viral with her YouTube parody **"Hunger Games (but better)"**
- **Reiter** exclusively told **Page Six** back in **Dec. 2025** she'd thought about whether she'd ever end up doing **SNL**
- **Season 52** premieres **Sept. 26** on **NBC**

The Debate Starter

- Can a viral YouTube parody actually predict who's going to make it on SNL, or is it a total coin flip?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 90/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 33 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/see-the-new-snl-cast-members-plus-our-grace-reiter-interview/

■ *More Like 'MobLand': 10 Best Guy Ritchie Movies and TV Shows to Watch on Netflix, Paramount+, Prime Video, and More*

The Angle: *He's the guy behind those fast-talking British crime movies you quote at parties, and now he's basically running his own mini-studio across every streamer - 'MobLand' is just the latest proof he's everywhere.*

- **Guy Ritchie** made his name on scrappy British gangster comedies before going full **Hollywood mogul**
- A new roundup ranks his **10 best movies and shows**, spread across **Netflix, Paramount+, and Prime Video**
- His newest, **'MobLand,'** is name-checked as the launch point for the list
- He's gone from cult indie director to a guy with projects across basically every major streaming platform

The Debate Starter

- Ask the hosts (and callers) to defend their pick for the *actual* best Guy Ritchie movie - 'Snatch,' 'Lock, Stock,' or something newer - and see if anyone agrees.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/09/18/best-guy-ritchie-movies-and-tv-shows-on-streaming/

■ *Tom Cruise lifts lid on his conversation with 'genius' Taylor Swift at Chiefs game*

The Angle: *Cruise and Swift's Chiefs-game friendship has been quietly trending all season, and now Cruise himself is dishing on what she's actually like one-on-one - easy tabloid crossover between Hollywood and Swiftie world.*

- **Tom Cruise** opened up about chatting with **Taylor Swift** at a **Chiefs** game
- His verdict: "**She's funny. She's got such a great sense of humor**"

- Cruise called her **"genius"** in the process

The Debate Starter

- Who's the most surprisingly funny celebrity you'd never expect to be a riot in person?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/18/entertainment/tom-cruise-lifts-lid-on-his-conversation-with-genius-taylor-swift-at-chiefs-game/

■ *James Gunn Is Trying to Temper Your 'Man of Tomorrow' Expectations*

The Angle: *DC boss James Gunn is publicly lowering the temperature on fan hype before the 2027 sequel even starts rolling out marketing, which is exactly the kind of "is he protecting the movie or admitting it's thinner than expected" debate fans love to chew on.*

- **James Gunn**, head of DC Studios, is telling fans not to expect **"secret characters"** in the upcoming film.
- The movie in question is **'Man of Tomorrow,'** slated for **summer 2027**.

The Debate Starter

- Is Gunn being smart by killing rumors early, or already managing expectations because the movie can't live up to the hype?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/james-gunn-is-trying-to-temper-your-man-of-tomorrow-expectations-2000813644

Backup options:

■ *Jamie Miller talks about his viral song 'Babydoll,' dancing with celebrities, and starting a new chapter*

The Angle: *Jamie Miller nearly walked away from music for good, and now his song 'Babydoll' is everywhere — it's the classic comeback story that always gets an audience rooting.*

- **Jamie Miller** had been grinding in music for almost **a decade** before **"Babydoll"** finally broke through
- He stepped away from music entirely for close to **two years** before this comeback
- Opens up on Page Six's **"Viral Deep Dive"** series about the song's unexpected rise
- Also talks dancing with celebrities and starting a fresh **"new chapter"** in his career

The Comeback Question

- Ever almost quit on a dream right before it paid off — what made you stick it out, or what made you walk away?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/video/jamie-miller-talks-about-his-viral-song-babydoll-dancing-with-celebrities-and-starting-a-new-chapter/

■ *Tom Cruise says Taylor Swift was "schooling me on football" at the Kansas City Chiefs game on Monday.*

The Angle: *Two of the biggest names on the planet sitting together at a Chiefs game is instant tabloid gold, and Cruise gushing about Swift's football IQ (and her writing, directing, everything) is the kind of odd-couple crossover moment that gets clipped everywhere.*

- **Tom Cruise** says **Taylor Swift** was "**schooling me on football**" at Monday's **Kansas City Chiefs** game.
- Cruise says they also talked **music and movies**.
- He called her "**funny**" with "**such a great sense of humor**."
- Cruise praised her as "**a brilliant writer**... **a brilliant musician and director** — very skilled."

The Debate Starter

- Is Tom Cruise a closet Swiftie now, or just being polite to the most powerful woman in football's luxury box?

X/Twitter @Variety (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/Variety/status/2100883212683644986

■ *'You're Not Going To Win Tonight With That Stupid Face': Ke Huy Quan Reveals Cruel Dig From Famous Actor*

The Angle: *An Oscar winner just aired out a nasty backstage dig from a fellow A-lister — that's instant Hollywood gossip gold, and everyone's going to want to know who said it.*

- **Ke Huy Quan** claims a famous actor told him: **"You're not going to win tonight with that stupid face."**
- The comment reportedly came right before a major award moment for **Quan**.
- The identity of the actor who said it hasn't been confirmed in what we've got so far.

Guess Who Said It

- Callers, take your shot: which A-lister do you think was cold enough to say that to Ke Huy Quan's face?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Drop The Quote** - Cold open, no names yet -> Read the line exactly as reported — 'You're not going to win tonight with that stupid face' — and let it sit for a beat.
- **Step 2: Hosts Guess First** - 30 seconds, no cheating -> Each host throws out one guess for which famous actor they think has that kind of petty energy.
- **Step 3: Open The Phones** - Quick caller round -> Take 2-3 caller guesses on air, ranking the wildest theory before moving on.

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/ke-huy-quan-unnamed-actor-sag-awards-memoir-1764162

■ *Millie Bobby Brown Welcomes Baby No. 2 with Husband Jake Bongiovi*

The Angle: *The Stranger Things star and her Bon Jovi-family husband just added a second kid to their fast-growing household — a quick, feel-good pop culture beat listeners will want the details on.*

- **Millie Bobby Brown** and husband **Jake Bongiovi** have welcomed their second child together.
- **Jake Bongiovi** is the son of rocker **Jon Bon Jovi**, keeping this one firmly in the celebrity-family spotlight.
- This marks baby No. 2 for the young couple, who married in **2024**.

The Quick Take

- From Netflix's biggest teen star to a two-time mom before 25 — how fast does that timeline feel to you?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://people.com/millie-bobby-brown-welcomes-second-baby-with-husband-jake-bongiovi-source-12125396?utm_campaign=peoplemagazine&utm_medium=social&utm_source=reddit.com&utm_content=post

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TRENDING TODAY

■ *Scientists Develop a Way to Restore Aging EV Batteries to Up to 95% of Their Original Capacity Instead of Breaking Them Down for Recycling, Potentially Giving Old Batteries a New Life.*

The Angle: *Everyone assumes EV batteries just die and get tossed - this is the opposite of that fear, and it plays into the bigger "is EV ownership actually practical long-term" conversation everyone's having.*

- Researchers found a way to restore old, degraded EV batteries back up to **95% of original capacity**
- Instead of the usual path - shredding worn-out batteries down for recycling - this method effectively **reverses the aging**
- Could mean **old EV batteries get a second life** instead of being scrapped

The Debate Starter

- Would this change your mind about buying a used EV if you knew the battery could basically be reset like new?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113894-scientists-develop-way-restore-aging-ev-batteries-without.html

Backup options:

■ *Julia Stiles calls out ‘diva’ Andy Cohen’s criticism of her dancing on ‘DWTS’ — and he responds - Page Six*

The Angle: *A bona fide '90s movie star is throwing shade at one of Bravo's biggest names live on network TV, and Derek Hough jumped in to pile on — that's a celebrity feud with legs, not just DWTS inside baseball.*

- **Julia Stiles** called out **Andy Cohen** on **"Dancing With the Stars"** Wednesday night over his criticism of her dancing.
- Stiles said she **"stopped taking dance classes"** because people expected her to be a certain kind of dancer, tying it back to Cohen's comments.
- **DWTS** host **Derek Hough** publicly sided with Stiles, declaring on air: **"Eat it, Andy Cohen!"**
- Cohen, who hosts Bravo's **"Watch What Happens Live,"** responded to the callout.

The Debate Starter

- Team Julia or Team Andy — who's actually in the wrong here?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/09/17/entertainment/julia-stiles-calls-out-diva-andy-cohens-criticism-on-dwts-and-he-responds/

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Study finds association between passenger vehicle size and pedestrian fatality rates. Every additional 100 kg of vehicle weight increased pedestrian fatality odds by 6%. Every additional 10 cm of vehicle height increased pedestrian fatality odds by 11%*

The Angle: *Everyone's noticed SUVs and pickups getting bigger every year - this study puts hard numbers on why that trend might actually be more dangerous for people walking, not just safer for people driving.*

- Every extra **100 kg** of vehicle weight bumped pedestrian fatality odds up **6%**
- Every extra **10 cm** of vehicle height bumped pedestrian fatality odds up **11%**
- Height mattered even more than weight - taller front ends, not just heavier vehicles, are the bigger factor

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever downsize your vehicle for pedestrian safety, or is a bigger ride a non-negotiable for you?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2210670726006633?via%3Dihub

Backup options:

■ *A new liquid biopsy blood test can now detect pancreatic cancer much earlier, when it’s not only more treatable but also when it’s precancerous and potentially curable. Pancreatic cancer has the lowest survival rates of any cancer. 90% have tumors detected at when the malignancy has already spread.*

The Angle: *Pancreatic cancer is basically the scariest diagnosis in oncology because it's almost always caught too late - this is a rare good-news health story that hits home for anyone who's lost someone to it.*

- It's a **liquid biopsy** - meaning a simple blood draw, not a scan or a surgical biopsy.
- Right now **90%** of pancreatic cancer cases aren't caught until the disease has already spread.
- Pancreatic cancer has the **lowest survival rate** of any major cancer.
- This test can flag it at the **precancerous stage** - before it's technically even cancer yet, and potentially curable.

The Personal Connection

- Everybody knows someone who's been touched by this disease - would you want to get a blood test like this just to know your risk, even before you had any symptoms?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cityofhope.org/research/research-news/new-study-blood-test-shows-promise-for-detecting-pancreatic-cancer-at-its-earliest-stages

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■ *New research shows that irritability is strongly associated with post-traumatic stress disorder symptoms, chronic pain and difficulty understanding speech in noisy environments among military veterans with chronic mild traumatic brain injury, or concussion.*

The Angle: *New research on military veterans found irritability isn't just a mood thing after a brain injury — it's tightly tied to PTSD symptoms, chronic pain, and even trouble hearing conversations in noisy rooms. It's a relatable hook for anyone who's noticed a veteran in their life get short-tempered since an injury, and it reframes 'irritability' as a real symptom worth taking seriously.*

- The study focuses on veterans living with **chronic mild traumatic brain injury** (a.k.a. concussion).
- Researchers found irritability is strongly linked to **PTSD symptoms** in this group.
- It's also connected to **chronic pain** and **trouble understanding speech in noisy environments**.
- The findings suggest irritability may be an underrated red flag doctors should screen for after head injuries.

The Empathy Check

- Anyone got a veteran in their life who's been way quicker to snap since a head injury — does this explain it?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.cuanschutz.edu/news-stories/study-finds-irritability-long-after-concussions-in-veterans-is-linked-to-ptsd-chronic-pain-and-hearing-difficulties?utm_campaign=veteran_ptsd&utm_source=reddit&utm_medium=social

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CLOSER: WHAT THE FRIDAY

■ *The day isn't even close to over and I already am done with it.*

The Angle: *It's Friday and the internet is already collectively exhausted — a viral vent-tweet like this is the perfect mirror for a 'What The Friday' segment where the hosts just need to commiserate on air.*

The Commiseration Corner

- What's the one thing that's already broken your Friday before noon?

X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful (Tier 1) | Score: 67/90 (40 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> STRONG

URL: https://x.com/WomenBeingAwful/status/2100655246246551830

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/4 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Indonesia is paying villagers to photograph wildlife instead of hunt it, helping turn animal hunters into protectors. The programme has already generated more than 350,000 wildlife observations, and two participating villages have voluntarily banned hunting.*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate 'give a man a reason' story - flip the incentive and poachers become photographers. Feel-good proof that conservation can work when you pay people to protect nature instead of just telling them to.*

- Villagers in **Indonesia** get paid to photograph wildlife instead of hunting it
- The program has racked up more than **350,000 wildlife observations**
- **Two villages** have voluntarily banned hunting altogether since joining in
- Former hunters are now acting as the animals' protectors

The Feel-Good Wrap

- Would you trade the thrill of the hunt for a paycheck and a camera - and is that a better deal for everybody, animals included?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://english.aawsat.com/varieties/5319326-indonesia-cash-photos-scheme-turns-animal-hunters-protectors

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■ *Andrew Tate Accuses Streamer Sneako of Trying To Have Sex With Him*

The Angle: *Two of the internet's most controversial personalities are now in a public feud over an accusation nobody saw coming — pure chaotic-online-culture fuel for a quick kicker segment.*

- **Andrew Tate** publicly accused streamer **Sneako** of trying to have sex with him
- Story is making rounds on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**, filed under 'too weird to be satire'

The WTF Headline

- You don't even need context for this one — just read the headline on air and let it land.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://sports.ndtv.com/us/us-streamers/andrew-tate-accuses-streamer-sneako-of-trying-to-have-sex-with-him-11630911

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Twin sisters conjoined at the head underwent successful separation surgery*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Conjoined twin separation surgeries are a rare, universally emotional medical-miracle story type that reliably outperforms its initial engagement numbers once picked up broadly.
The Angle: *It's the kind of against-the-odds medical miracle that makes a perfect show closer — a rare, high-risk surgery that actually worked out for two little girls.*

- The twins were born **conjoined at the head** — known medically as craniopagus, one of the rarest and riskiest forms of conjoined twins.
- They underwent a **successful separation surgery**, a procedure that typically requires multiple surgical teams and can stretch on for many hours.

The Feel-Good Finish

- This is the kind of story you end the show on — a reminder that sometimes the long-shot surgery actually works.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://abcnews.com/GMA/Wellness/2-year-twins-conjoined-head-underwent-successful-separation/story?id=136489246

■ *North Korean anthem played at South Korean field hockey match at Asian Games*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The same North Korean-anthem-at-Asian-Games story is independently posted twice (indices 5 and 7), a sign it's already generating organic cross-posting momentum around a genuinely surprising geopolitical/sports collision.
The Angle: *North Korean anthem played at South Korean field hockey match at Asian Games*

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.espn.ph/olympics/story/_/id/49971431/north-korean-anthem-played-south-korean-field-hockey-match-asian-games

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■ *Archbishop of Canterbury revokes award given to cleric who praised Osama bin Laden*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): An Archbishop of Canterbury publicly revoking an award over bin Laden praise is a startling institutional scandal with a big-name figure, and it's also been independently posted twice, suggesting real pickup.
The Angle: *The Archbishop of Canterbury just revoked an honor from a cleric after it came out he praised Osama bin Laden - the kind of 'wait, THAT happened?' headline that's tailor-made for r/nottheonion.*

- The **Archbishop of Canterbury** pulled an award that had already been handed to a cleric.
- The reason: that cleric had **praised Osama bin Laden**.
- Story is blowing up on **r/nottheonion** for how wild the premise sounds.

The Facepalm Moment

- How does someone get an award in the first place after praising Bin Laden?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.sky.com/story/archbishop-of-canterbury-revokes-award-given-to-cleric-who-praised-osama-bin-laden-13589162

■ *Boston University English Majors Must Prove They Can Write Without AI*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): It taps directly into the red-hot 'AI is eroding writing skills' debate dominating education discourse right now, giving it built-in relevance beyond its origin subreddit.
The Angle: *Boston University's English department is reportedly pushing students back to in-class, pen-and-paper writing to prove they're not leaning on ChatGPT — a sign the AI cheating panic on campus has gone from rumor to actual policy change.*

- **Boston University**'s English program is reportedly requiring students to demonstrate writing ability without AI assistance.
- The move reflects a growing wave of universities rethinking take-home essays in the **ChatGPT** era.
- It raises the bigger question of how any school can actually *prove* a paper is AI-free.

The Debate Starter

- If you were grading papers right now, would you trust a take-home essay — or make everyone write it out by hand in front of you?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gadgetreview.com/boston-university-english-majors-must-prove-they-can-write-without-ai

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■ *US chip fabs face massive 157,000 worker shortfall, mere 3% of US engineering grads enter chipmaking — despite six-figure salaries, US chip manufacturers are in dire need of engineers and technicians*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The eye-popping 157,000-worker chip shortfall stat plugs straight into the ongoing CHIPS Act/reshoring narrative and gives hosts a concrete, quotable number to build a segment around.
The Angle: *The US is pouring billions into building chip factories, but there might not be anyone to run them — a massive worker gap that threatens the whole plan to bring high-tech manufacturing back home.*

- US chip fabs are facing a staggering **157,000 worker shortfall**
- Only about **3%** of US engineering grads are going into chipmaking
- This shortage exists **despite six-figure salaries** on offer

The Debate Starter

- If six-figure pay can't fill these jobs, is it a money problem, a prestige problem, or a 'nobody wants to work in a factory' problem?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/semiconductors/us-chip-manufacturers-are-in-dire-need-of-engineers-and-technicians-experts-suggest-a-shortage-of-up-to-157-000-semiconductor-workers-by-2030

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)
- "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)
- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: 'So Much to Be Grateful for' - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here's Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at 'Josie and the Pussycats' 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces 'Songs in the Key of Life' 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani's toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live's 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "'Practical Magic 2' Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of "Sunday in the Park With George" has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 1 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 2 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

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